Social Security Number (SSN) Requirement Introduction	Number	Page
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Revision Date:
June 1, 2020

Background:
Every person requesting Medi-Cal who has a Social Security Number (SSN) at the time of application is asked to provide it regardless of immigration status. The applicant can indicate if they have a SSN in Section D on the MC 13.

Purpose:
04.11.01A
This section establishes procedures for the following:
- Situations where the customer is unable to provide or does not have a SSN
- SSN validation process
- SSN validation error resolution procedures

1. **Policy:**
04.11.01B
As a condition of eligibility for full-scope Medi-Cal benefits, each customer must either provide acceptable verification of SSN or cooperate in obtaining a SSN.

The following customers are exempt from this requirement:
- Infants under the Deemed Eligibility program
- Refugees under Refugee Medical Assistance/Entrant Medical Assistance (RMA/EMA) program

2. **Procedure:**
04.11.01C SSN Verification
Verification must be received within 60 days of the date of application but not necessarily prior to the approval of eligibility.

NOTE: Human Services Specialists (HSS) must apply SB 87 regulations before requesting SSN verification from a customer and attempt to verify the SSN through the *ex parte* process outlined in MPG 4.7.12.

Acceptable SSN verification includes:
- Social Security card
- SSA form series OA-702
- SSA award letter
- SSN notification letters for IRCA aliens
- Medicare card
- SSA check showing the applicant's name and SSN with the letters A, HA, J, T or M following the SSN
- Income Eligibility Verification System (IEVS) applicant report with a code "A" or "W" in the SSN-VER field

04.11.01D Cooperation Verification
Acceptable verifications of cooperation include:
- Completed application for a Social Security card Form SS-5
- MC 194 referral form annotated by a SSA official indicating that a completed form has been submitted
- Form SSA-2853 "MESSAGE FROM SOCIAL SECURITY" signed by an official of the hospital where the baby was born
    - Note: this form is not required for newborns qualified for Deemed Eligibility
- Proof of their attempt to apply for the number when SSA has not accepted the SSN application because of lack of documentation as outlined in MPG 04.11.02E

04.11.01E Restricted Benefits
Non-citizens eligible only for restricted benefits are NOT required to provide a SSN as a condition of eligibility. The HSS will leave the SSN field blank in CalWIN. MEDS will issue a pseudo-SSN for the MEDS record.

If a non-citizen …	Then …
eligible for restricted Medi-Cal claims to have a SSN but refuses to provide it,	• grant eligibility if all other eligibility requirements are met • submit a referral to the State Medi-Cal investigator if there is reason to believe that they are withholding any information relevant to their Medi-Cal eligibility or SOC
provides a SSN,	use the SSN: • on form MC221 • to obtain an IEVS via 14-28 • for any other mandated purposes

NOTE: Under no circumstances should a HSS knowingly submit an incorrect or fraudulent SSN to MEDS.

Program Impacts:
No Impact to other programs

References:
ACWDL 17-01
MEDIL 10-03
MPG Letter 750 (04/12)

Sunset Date:
This policy will be reviewed for continuance by May 31, 2023

Approval for Release:

Rick Wanne, Director
Eligibility Operations

Revision Date:
June 1, 2020

Background:
This section describes the policies for referring customers to SSA for a Social Security number (SSN).

Purpose:
This section is re-written in the new format. Policies have been updated to remove references to Immigration Reform and Control Act (IRCA) aliens. Procedures are moved to Processing Guide 31.

Policy:
When to Refer to SSA:
Refer customers to SSA in the following situations when the:
- Customer cannot provide an acceptable SSN verification
- Customer does not have a SSN
- SSN is not validated by SSA and the case review and/or customer states the County information is correct
- Customer's date of birth does not match SSA files and the customer has proof of the correct date of birth.

Who to Refer to SSA:
The following people will be referred to SSA if they meet the criteria outlined above:
- United States (U.S.) citizens
- Immigrants that can provide SSA with one of the following documents:
    - AR 3
    - AR 3a
    - I-94
    - I-95
    - I-151
    - I-181a/b
    - I-184
    - I-185
    - I-186
    - I-551
    - I-688
    - I-688A
    - SW434

Failure to Cooperate in Applying for and/or Providing the SSN:
Examples of failure to cooperate include, but are not limited to, when the customer:
- States that he/she will not provide the SSN if available or will not apply for SSN on his/her own behalf or a child's
- Refuses to provide information to SSA that is accessible to him/her
- Fails to return the MC 194 after he/she was instructed to apply/reapply for the SSN

- Fails to obtain and submit the documentation required by SSA within 30 days of the date that the original SSN application was submitted but not accepted by SSA for lack of documentation.

See Processing Guide 31 when the client has refused to apply for or provide the SSN.

Procedure:
Referral Procedures:
See Processing Guide 31 to refer the customer to SSA.

Form MC 194 Not Accepted Due to Lack of Evidence:
See Processing Guide 31 when SSA indicates on the MC 194 that the application for SSN was submitted but not accepted due to lack of evidence.

Form MC 194 Accepted by SSA:
See Processing Guide 31 when the customer returns the MC 194 indicating that the SSN application was accepted.

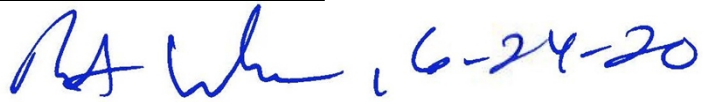
Responses to Request for SSN:
See Processing Guide 31 when the customer responds to the requests for the SSN indicating that he/she has not received the SSN.

Program Impacts:
None.

References:
Medi-Cal Eligibility Procedures Manual 4M(II)A

Sunset Date:
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Approval for Release:



Rick Wanne, Director
Eligibility Operations

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June 1, 2020

Background:
The Department of Health Care Services (DHCS) has initiated a process in which the Social Security numbers (SSNs) of Medi-Cal beneficiaries are matched against Social Security Administration's (SSA) records. This process is called validation.

The process has two parts, the validation process and the referral process.

Process	Function
Validation	A daily match of all invalidated SSNs currently on the Medi-Cal Eligibility Data System (MEDS).
Referral	Ongoing matching of people referred to SSA for either a replacement SSN card or an initial application. Includes those people who could not be "validated" in the daily process. Note: The referral process will update MEDS on a daily basis.

Purpose:
This section is re-written in the new format. No policies or procedures are changed, though procedures are moved to Processing Guide 32.

Policy:
Validation Error Resolution:
To resolve invalidated SSNs, compare the invalidated data with the case record to determine where the error is.

To compare the invalidated data with the case record data to determine if errors were made in the information forwarded to the state, check for:

- Incorrect SSN (for example, SSN belongs to another family member)
- Transposition of a number in the SSN
- Incorrect digit(s) in the SSN
- Incorrect spelling of the first and/or last name
- Use of maiden name instead of married name
- Use of nickname or the use of two surnames for any of the children
- Incorrect gender and/or date of birth

If …	Then …
Errors are found in either the CalWIN or MEDS record,	• Correct the information in CalWIN • Submit 14-28 to MEDS operator to have the MEDS record corrected.
No errors are found in either the CalWIN or MEDS record,	Contact the beneficiary to verify the information by: • Requesting to view SSN card • Questioning the beneficiary if he/she used another name when

	applying for a SSN • Requesting date of birth verification to compare with the month and year shown on the report.

The SSA/DHCS data match compares SSN in the following method and order:
1. First six letters of the last name
2. First letter of first name
3. Gender
4. Year and month of birth

If any of these fields do not match, SSA notifies DHCS of those SSNs that were not validated. Specific data element(s) that caused the mismatch are not identified. Continue to check data elements after discovering inaccuracies to prevent duplicate invalidated SSN reports.

All corrections will be processed through MEDS and will be included in the next State Validation file submittal to SSA.

If the …	Then …
Record returns as "validated,"	The State files will be updated accordingly.
Beneficiary indicates that the worker has the correct information,	Refer the beneficiary to SSA as outlined below.

Referral Error Resolution:
See Processing Guide 32 to resolve invalidated SSNs or discrepancies in the SSN information.

Second MC 194 Returned:
SSA may respond with either of the following when they return Form MC 194 for a beneficiary that has been referred to SSA a second time:
- SSA is revising its record to match the State record for each discrepant item
- SSA is not revising its record for at least one item but may be revising other items.

If SSA is revising their record, no action is necessary. See Processing Guide 32 if SSA is not revising its record.

Procedure:
See above.

Program Impacts:
None.

References:
Medi-Cal Eligibility Procedures Manual 4M(II)A

Sunset Date:
This policy will be reviewed for continuance by May 31, 2023

Approval for Release:

6-24-20

Rick Wanne, Director
Eligibility Operations

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June 1, 2020

Background:
MEDS will receive information from all the validation processes. This information will be compared to the MEDS database and this exception message will be generated: SS30 – SSN citizenship and identity validation.

Purpose:
This section is re-written in the new format. No policies or procedures are changed, though procedures are moved to Processing Guide 33.

Policy:
Referral Processing:
If the Social Security Administration (SSA) and MEDS information is not consistent enough to validate the Social Security Number (SSN) the following will occur:

- An alert is added to the MEDS beneficiary record
- MEDS Name Cross Reference File is also updated to include the name and birth date from the referral record.

If the …	Then the MEDS beneficiary record …
Beneficiary information is consistent,	Is updated to show that the SSN was validated.
SSA and MEDS information is not consistent enough to validate the SSN,	Has an alert added to show the error.

Referral Alerts:
Referral alerts are issued when:

- Follow-up action is needed for MEDS
- Information obtained from the referral may be useful to the worker.

Referral alerts will appear in CalWIN as MEDS Exceptions. For a listing of these messages, see Desk Aid 107.

Procedures:
Validation Process:
See Processing Guide 33 for the validation process.

SSN Changes:
See Processing Guide 33 for SSN changes.

Date of Birth Changes:
See Processing Guide 33 for date of birth changes.

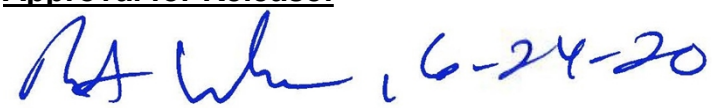
Date of Birth Changes Previously Reported:
See Processing Guide 33 for when the beneficiary has reported a date of birth change and the new date of birth was entered in CalWIN.

Program Impacts:
None.

References:
Medi-Cal Eligibility Procedures Manual 4M(II)A

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Approval for Release:



Rick Wanne, Director
Eligibility Operations